Conflict of Interest Policy

1 Purpose

A conflict of interest arises when a person's duty to Girl Pride Africa Kenya (GPAK) could be affected, or could reasonably appear to be affected, by a separate interest of their own or of someone close to them. This policy helps everyone connected to GPAK recognise a conflict, declare it, and keep it from affecting a decision, so that participant selection, recruitment, procurement and payments stay fair.

2 Definitions

Type of interest	What it means
Financial interest	A person, or a relative, has a financial stake in a decision GPAK is making, for example owning or working for a business bidding to supply GPAK, or standing to gain from a payment GPAK approves.
Family interest	A person's relative (spouse, parent, child, sibling, or another close relative or person they support) is affected by a decision, for example being a participant, a mentor mother, a community volunteer, a supplier or a school being considered for a GPAK role, a support decision or a contract.
Personal interest	A close personal relationship, friendship or rivalry that could affect a person's judgement in a decision, without a financial or family element.
Community interest	A person's standing or relationships within the counties and wards where GPAK works could affect, or appear to affect, a decision, for example selecting a mentor mother, a community volunteer or a participant from among people the decision-maker knows personally.

3 Duty to declare

Every GPAK staff member, Advisory Committee member, mentor mother, community volunteer, intern, consultant and contractor declares any interest that could affect their work for GPAK:

- On appointment, using the declaration of interests form in Annex A.
- Every year after that, whether or not anything has changed.
- As soon as a new conflict arises, before taking part in the decision it affects.

Declarations are kept in the conflicts register (Annex B), which the Secretary of the Advisory Committee and the Director each keep up to date for their respective areas.

4 How a conflict is managed

1. The person tells the relevant decision-maker (their supervisor, the Director, or the Chair of the Advisory Committee if the Director holds the conflict) as soon as they recognise it.
2. The person withdraws from the decision, discussion or approval step the conflict affects, and this is recorded in the minutes, the register or the relevant file.
3. An independent approver, who does not share the conflict, takes the decision instead.
4. The interest and how it was managed are recorded in the conflicts register (Annex B).
5. Where a conflict cannot be managed this way, for example because only one person can approve a particular payment, the Director, or the Chair if the Director holds the conflict, decides how the decision is taken instead, and records the reason.

5 Specific rules

- No staff member selects, approves support for, or procures goods or services from, a relative.
- No staff member, mentor mother or community volunteer takes part in the eligibility screening (F1) or selection decision for a participant who is their relative.
- No staff member or volunteer selects, approves support for, or procures from, a school, health facility or supplier where a relative works, teaches or holds an interest.
- No staff member or Advisory Committee member takes part in a procurement decision above the thresholds in POL-09 where they, or a relative, has an interest in the supplier.
- No staff member approves their own expense claim, stipend, advance or reimbursement; the Director's own claims are approved by the Finance Officer and the Chair of the Advisory Committee.
- An Advisory Committee member does not take part in a decision where a participant, supplier, school, mentor mother, community volunteer or staff member is their family member and this creates a conflict, and does not vote on a matter affecting their own appointment, any remuneration, or their removal.

6 Mentor mothers, community volunteers and participant selection

Recruitment of mentor mothers and community volunteers, and selection of participants for school fees and supplies support (F10) or starter kits (F14) or other limited-place support, records a conflict-of-interest declaration from each person taking part in the decision, stating whether a candidate is their relative or close associate. Where a candidate is a decision-maker's relative or close associate, that decision-maker withdraws under section 4 and an independent person completes the selection.

Approval and review

Item	Detail
Policy owner	Director
Approved by	Advisory Committee
Applies to	All GPAK staff, Advisory Committee members, volunteers, mentor mothers, community volunteers, interns, consultants, contractors and partners working on GPAK activities
Review	Every two years, or earlier if the law, a funder requirement or an incident review shows that a change is needed.

Public copy. Internal forms, annexes and signature pages are kept on file by GPAK and are available on request.